

person on their own wants their place to be furnished exactly like the home they just came from, complete with television, stereo, blender, and computer. These items cost money and, more times than not, are paid for with borrowed funds (credit cards or loans). Until this trend is stopped, debt levels will continue to be unacceptably high. Take a look at a partial inventory of one shared dorm room at California Lutheran University:

- 4 computers
- 2 cordless phones
- 2 TVs
- Over 300 CDs
- 2 mini-refrigerators
- 1 microwave oven
- 2 pairs of in-line skates
- 2 secondhand sofas
- 7 pairs of sneakers
- Number of vehicle it took to move in: 7
- 4 printers
- 3 cell phones
- 3 stereos
- 80 DVDs and 1 DVD rack
- 1 toaster
- 1 vacuum cleaner
- 1 pair of skis and poles
- 15 impressionist posters

The comedian George Carlin once said that the only reason we move to bigger houses is because we have more stuff. How much stuff do you have?

Dealing with Peer Pressure

Peer pressure can be a very strong influence in decisions of all kinds. The need to fit in becomes a strong influence on our actions. If we are surrounded by others who are richer than we are, we may feel the need to upgrade our clothes, our cars, and our entertainment choices to match theirs. This upgrading requires money which can become a problem if you're trying to compete with another student whose dad is the CEO of a Fortune 500 company.

Ultimately, self-esteem comes from believing in yourself for

